Hands-on Lab: Develop Your Personal Portfolio

If you are seeking a job in the BI domain, a portfolio significantly improves your chances of securing one. This lab guides you through the steps of creating a highly effective portfolio.

Estimated time needed: 2 hours

A portfolio is a collection of samples of your best work. You can only list your skills in a resume; however, a portfolio helps you showcase those skills to a potential employer. A well-organized portfolio will set you apart from your competition, increasing your chances of securing your dream job.

Learning Objectives:

- Gather the information that should go into your portfolio.
- Put together a portfolio that you can showcase to potential employers.

Gather the information that should go into your portfolio

Here is a list of information that should be included in your portfolio.

- Personal information such as your name, and contact details (residential address, email address, and phone number).
- Your photograph.
- A brief description of yourself and your career goals.
- Descriptions of BI-related projects you have worked on and your role in the project.
- Work samples demonstrating your BI skills. These could include data analysis projects, data visualization examples, reports and presentation samples, case studies, BI tools and technologies, and real-world data projects.

Put together a portfolio

Now that you have all the necessary information and work samples, it's time to assemble your portfolio. Here are some steps to follow.

Think about the format

There are various ways to present your portfolio, but a digital medium is preferable for a BI portfolio. You can create a portfolio website or present it in the form of a PDF. No medium is inherently right or wrong; it depends on what employers prefer and how you can effectively communicate your skills.

Include basic personal information

Include your headshot, your full name, and contact information (residential address, email address, and phone number)

Provide a brief introduction

Provide a brief introduction of yourself. Discuss your educational background, why you chose BI, and your career aspirations. You may also mention your interests outside of work to give employers a better understanding of who you are.

Highlight work on BI projects

Actual work experience is always valued. If you have prior experience in the BI domain, choose relevant projects that you can include in the portfolio. Describe each project and your role in it. If possible, include work samples and screenshots.

Work samples

Include skill-specific work samples demonstrating your proficiency in BI-related tasks like data analysis, data visualization, and the use of tools like Microsoft Excel, IBM Cognos, Tableau, Looker, and Power BI.

Tips for organizing the portfolio

- You don't have to include all your work. Include your best work while showcasing a specific skill. Avoid including sub-standard work as it may create a poor impression.
- Tailor your portfolio to match the job descriptions and highlight the skills the employer is seeking.
- Use clear and simple language in your descriptions.
- Organize your portfolio with clear sections and headings.
- Label all charts, graphs, and dashboards.
- Include links to dashboards for a more interactive experience.

Congratulations! You have completed this lab activity.

Author(s)

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